Broken Ribs & Mending Hearts

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Not Rated

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra)

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Broken Ribs & Mending Hearts

by 1uxian

Summary

"But, it could just be nothing, right?"

Catra looked away regretfully, shattering Adora once again.

"I wouldn't hold my breath, Grayskull."

"You've got a twisted sense of humour, you know that?"

-

A car accident. A hot doctor. Respiratory complications.

What could go wrong?

(A lot. A lot could go wrong.)

Notes

help i cant write summaries

i spent the entire day researching shit for this
please enjoy it

im NOT A DOCTOR, please dont slag me off for my lack of medical knowledge i swear im trying

See the end of the work for more notes

Chapter 1

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"*Sweetheart, I need you to speak to me*."

What had happened? Everything was a blur.

"*Can you tell me your name*?"

She was driving, wasn't she? She was going to meet someone.

"*Hon, what's your name*?"

Glimmer and Bow. It had to have been. How did she end up here? She was driving, and she glanced to the side. Did she crash? Maybe she swerved a little.

"*Can you hear me*?"

Her head started to feel fuzzier by the second, like television static. She felt like somebody had driven a sword through her chest and her stomach. She tried to make a sound at the numbing pain in her leg, but remained silent. She felt foreign hands prodding her face, prising her eyelids open, flashing lights in her vision, pressing cold metal to her body.

"*Patient is unresponsive, get her into the ambulance*."

Her thoughts felt drunk as she tried to recollect herself. She had *glanced*. She wasn't even as bad a driver now! She felt cold plastic touch her face that felt as if it was pumping cold, flavored air down her throat. Soon, her vision blacked out again, and her mind numbed.

—

Beep… beep… beep…

Adora groaned, and tried to reach out for her alarm clock, but couldn't. Her arm felt stuck by her side as her senses slowly began to kick in. That sound wasn't her alarm clock, was it? This wasn't her room, either. Her room didn't smell of bleach.

She cracked one eye open, only to shut it immediately after. It was too *bright*.

Okay. Okay.

She decided to be logical about this. Figure out what was going on instead, working her way from the bottom to the top.

Her feet felt fine, so did her ankles. She winced as the pain in her right thigh kicked in, and she realised her leg was elevated. Her hips felt fine, if not a little bruised. She winced as she felt her insides flare up in pain. She couldn't be specific, but her abdomen was on fire.

Notably, her ribcage. She realised she had a plastic mask over her mouth and nose that must have been supplying her oxygen. A few of her ribs were probably broken, she could tell that much.

Her arm was in a sling, and she could feel it concealed in a hardened cast. She lifted her free, slightly bruised arm to remove the oxygen mask, only to be caught in a coughing fit.

"Trying to kill yourself already, hotshot?"

Adora opened her eyes again, successfully this time. Her room wasn't anything exceptional, just a standard hospital prison cell. At least to Adora. Just the thought of lazing around in a bed all day while everyone is watching your every move? Adora would shiver if she didn't feel *dead*.

Her gaze landed on the source of the voice. The hot voice, she would admit.

And, damn, hot woman. Then it struck her.

“Oh my god,” Adora groaned, her voice sounding strained and croaky from her coughing fit. “I *am* dead, aren’t I?”

The hot doctor let out a squeaky laugh, before picking up a clipboard and walking over to her.

What was this, Grey’s Anatomy? There was no way this goddess was her doctor. There was no way. Maybe she was just a mirage, and she was high on the saline drip or something.

If that was what was going on here, Adora had one hell of a creative mind. Her hair was an untamed mess, looking like it was wrestled into the ponytail behind her. Her frame was slightly smaller than Adora’s, and looked her age. Her facial features were sharp, and Adora noticed her eyes were two different colours; gorgeous shades of aquamarine and amber.

“Adora, right?” The woman said, glancing at the clipboard again. “I’m Catra, I’ll be supervising you during your recovery. Hate to break it to you, but you are in fact still alive, in one piece. Mostly.”

Adora opened her mouth and shut it again, like a clueless fish. Hell, who was she kidding? Even a damn fish probably had more of a clue than she did right now.

“Okay, looks like you were in a pretty bad car crash. Three of your ribs on the left of your chest were broken, one of which close to puncturing your aorta. I’ve already lined you up for a surgery to bolt you up, so that should be fine.”

Adora nodded slowly, her brain still feeling too slow to fully comprehend the situation. Her doctor did not just say she was going to bolt her up unironically.

“Additionally, you fractured your femoral shaft, which will also require surgical treatment, and I’ve scheduled that for tomorrow morning.”

“When can I walk?” Adora asked immediately, worry lacing her tone, almost afraid to hear the answer.

"Well, depending on how successful the procedure goes and how bad the damage is, it should take around three to six months to heal fully, if you stay away from tobacco products. You'll need a few weeks of physical therapy, but you should be fine."

Well, now Adora would *rather* be dead. Six months of no walking? What was she meant to do? She can't play soccer if she's got no leg to *kick* the damn ball with! Just like that, her career was over. Catra must have noticed the distressed look on her face.

"Chill, Grayskull. I know who you are. Your coach already stormed in here a few hours ago, she was saying to take all the time you need," she waved off. Adora's stomach attempted professional gymnastics at the fact her straight(?)-out-of-Grey's-Anatomy doctor knew who she was!

Well, one could say you lived under a rock if you hadn't heard of Brightmoon's soccer team captain, who had lead them to multiple victories. But still!

Adora didn't believe her coach came looking for her. She knew for a fact Netossa had set up a heavy training session for the team. If it was even the same day. Either way, she was too much of a busy woman. Adora appreciated the lie, anyway.

"Anyway," Catra snapped her out of her thoughts, but before she could continue Adora started to cough up her kidneys. "Right," she continued when Adora was done. "You've also received blunt force trauma to your torso as a whole. You suffered internal bleeding in your abdomen, but you've already been in surgery for a procedure since it was worse than mild. You've also got a bruised lung as a result of a broken rib."

Adora sputtered herself into another, and well-timed coughing fit.

"Fortunately, from what we can tell it isn't too severe, and no fluids were detected in your lung. To verify the extent of the injuries, you will be brought in for an x-rays, CT scans to your chest, and testing that your oxygen levels are all good. I'll also

recommend oxygen therapy to ease breathing.” Catra let out a sigh, looking up from her clipboard.

“Other than that? Fractured humerus, sprained wrist and knee. You’re lucky you didn’t suffer any major trauma to your head.”

“I don’t feel very lucky,” Adora grumbled. Honestly, she still wasn’t completely convinced she wasn’t dead.

“Uh huh,” Catra shook her head. “I’ll check on you later, Grayskull. Try not to kill yourself by then.”

Adora might’ve blushed at the smirk Catra gave her if she didn’t feel like a hyena was shredding her organs.

—

“*Adora*!”

A familiar voice shrieked her name from outside her prison cell. Adora straightened up as she eagerly awaited human contact from the outside world. A few seconds later, Glimmer burst through the door, panting. She was shortly followed by Bow, who looked as though he chased Glimmer down the length of the hallway.

Her shorter friend rushed to her side, hugging her awkwardly while trying to avoid everything she was hooked up to.

“How do you feel? What happened? Oh god, are you okay?” She rambled, grabbing Adora’s cheeks.

“I’m fine, *mom*,” she rolled her eyes, choking back another cough. “Just a little oopsie on the road.”

“Oh, Adora,” Bow gasped, wrapping an arm around her shoulder gently.

“We came as soon as we heard,” Glimmer explained, before pulling a backpack off her back. “We brought some of your stuff! Your phone, headphones, char-”

"*Hey*!"

All three heads snapped to the door, where sounds of light footsteps bounding down the hallway got louder and louder. Glimmer and Bow shared an anxious look, one which Adora did not miss.

"You guys didn't… Y'know. Break in here, did you?" She raised an eyebrow.

Glimmer patted her right on the messy hair poof Adora tried to give herself when single-handedly trying to tie her hair back. She dumped the backpack on the floor next to the bed, before Catra busted the door open.

"Sparkles, Croptop, *out*! No visitors means *no visitors*!" She yelled, holding up a clipboard threateningly. Adora's frame shook as she tried to conceal another cough, making it look like she was trying to gag up her week's worth of breakfast.

"We'll see you soon Adora!" Bow squeaked as he was chased out the door by Catra.

"*Loveyoubye*!" Glimmer waved, following Bow out. Catra rolled her eyes and left the room, throwing a quick glance in the Adora's area, who only hoped Catra didn't notice her heart rate pick up after her entrance.

Chapter End Notes

jujhkll KUDOS AND COMMENTS APPRECIATED

Chapter 2

Chapter Notes

unholy by sam smith is kind of a bop ngl

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora didn't like to be left alone with her thoughts.

She was sitting up, rigid in her bed as she awaited to be prepped for her fracture repair surgery. Her thigh was still in excruciating pain, not unlike her torso. She willed time to go faster, go *faster*. Then finally her mind could be at rest under anesthesia, and she wouldn't have to feel the pain. For a few hours, anyway. And she could stop trying to convince herself the plain white walls were worth more of her thoughts than the accident.

Every time the sound of a whirring car speeding by leaked into her ears, she would soon notice her heart monitor speeding up. She pretended not to, because it was fine. Just because one little car crash has landed her here, with a few broken ribs and a useless leg, doesn't mean she can't move on from this.

She was *Adora*. She could persevere through anything. Sure, the accident was less than forty-eight hours previous, but she was stronger. She *willed* herself to be stronger.

Every inch of her, though bruised and broken, was aching for some form of physical activity. She wanted nothing more in those hours than to go to the gym and run and lift and hit and kick until her mind was at ease again. Her muscles felt tensed up as she laid motionless in the bed for what seemed like an eternity and a half.

The lack of socialising was also starting to make her go a little insane. Only droning conversations with the odd doctor checking her vitals kept her sanity going. But, of course, that was when Catra wasn't around. Adora's mind just started to drift off

daydreaming of her doctor's brain-numbing face when the creaky sound of the door opening echoed around the room.

"Alright, hotshot," that familiar voice she had been waiting to hear all day said with a slight rasp. "You're up now, just checking a few things before we head to the op room."

Adora nodded silently, clearing her throat - partly because her lungs were still on the fritz, partly because Catra definitely added that sway of her hip on purpose and goddamnit Adora you're staring again - as she pulled out a thermometer from one of the many drawers.

"Open," Catra said as she held it up to Adora's mouth. The blonde flushed and looked anywhere but the woman as she took the cold metal beneath her tongue. It really shouldn't have been as embarrassing as it was; that was Catra's *job*. But Adora didn't want to look like a giant baby who couldn't do things for herself. How was she meant to make an impression in this state? Bedridden and coughing until she couldn't breathe on a regular basis? Not a hot look.

"Feelin' okay?" Catra broke the silence.

"Mmhhm," Adora responded around the thermometer. She really didn't, but she wasn't about to admit she couldn't handle a little pain.

Catra removed it, glancing at the number approvingly. She glanced at the monitor, betraying Adora at her heart's pace. Catra hummed at the number.

"Nervous?"

No. You're just ridiculously attractive and I don't know how to act around you.

"A little."

Catra picked up the sphygmomanometer from the desk and started to strap it around Adora's bicep. She blushed and silently prayed her heart to stop trying to outrun a cheetah as the warmth of Catra's fingertips lingered on her arm for a quarter of a second.

"So, you work out a lot?" Catra asked as she began to pump the inflation bulb. "Other than soccer, I mean."

"When I can," Adora replied, trying her best to sound nonchalant. She doesn't miss Catra's eyeroll accompanying a small smile.

"Okay, so your lung is still a little fucked," Catra began, unstrapping the band. Adora wondered if she was allowed to swear around patients. "So we're going to have to hook you up with a endotracheal tube in the op, alright?" She doesn't wait for an answer, unclamping one of the bed legs to free it for wheeling. "Your anesthesiologist will be in here in a few minutes to speak with you, and knock you out."

Adora felt a small laugh bubble in her throat, her lung aching as she breathed out.

"M'kay, see you then, Adora," Catra smirked, leaving the room. Adora stared aimlessly at the creaking door, heart thumping. The way her name just rolled off Catra's tongue in her sweet, raspy tone certainly *did things* for her.

You idiot, that's your doctor.

But when I get out…

Oh, Adora, dream on!

She spent the next seven minutes wondering if dating a former doctor was legal or not while picking at the loose thread at the top of her baby blue hospital-issued blanket. She was about to do some google research, when Catra reentered the room with who she assumed was her anesthesiologist.

“Hiya!” The woman beamed. She was built tall and big; clearly worked out regularly. Her hair was white-blonde and cut short. Some of Adora’s anxieties evaporated at the woman’s general aura; she seemed very kind, like the kid in your class who opted for bringing the spider outside instead of stamping on it. “I’m Scorpia, and I’ll be your anesthesiologist for a while. Basically I will be monitoring your vitals and obviously, anesthesia, during the procedure. Your pain control, pretty much!”

Adora started choking a little as Scorpia got behind the bed and started to wheel her out of the room, Catra holding the doors open on the way to the op. Her heart rate picked up, this time not because of her doctor. She did enough research in her own time to know she was getting a rod shoved into her leg for a while. Though the prospect was scary and she knew it’d hurt like hell - more than now, too - she would rather that and being able to start her recovery and being able to *move* again, than not.

When they finally reached a new room, Adora waited patiently for her doctors and nurses to enter the room, as well as Scorpia scrubbing in. A while later, when the room came more alive, Adora hardly winced at the sharp pinch in her arm, realising it was Scorpia injecting her with what she assumed was her sedative.

Scorpia explained the drug but Adora couldn’t hear her properly after she caught sight of the endotracheal tube Catra told her she needed. “You’ll feel a little sleepy and funny, but you’ll wake up and we’ll be finished!”

Less than a minute later, the ‘funny’ feeling kicked in. Everyone’s voices sounded underwater, and her body started to numb. It almost felt eerily like how she remembered it did right after the accident. She felt like she was looking at the world from a third person perspective. Catra said something to Scorpia, or maybe it was Adora, and it looked like she was going to leave.

“Catra,” she called quietly, narrowing her eyes at her. Catra bit the inside of her cheek to stop herself from smiling at the drunk-looking woman. “Fight me,” she said tiredly.

“Maybe later,” Catra laughed, until the sweet sound melted away. Before she could think of a response, or think at *all*, her mind went blank and Adora fell into a peaceful sleep at last.

Chapter End Notes

yall whys my dog snoring so loudly wtf...

THANK YOU FOR READING:DDD
KUDOS AND COMMENTS ARE MY LIFE SUPPORT

Chapter 3

Chapter Notes

HOOOOLY SHIT GUYS
400 hits already??
thank u so so so much if youve made it to here and left kudos/comments:)))
enjoyyy

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The first thing Adora felt after regaining consciousness was how completely dry her throat was.

She also felt sick to her stomach. She was confused, and laid on her back for what felt like hours wracking her brain for explanations. It came back to her, slowly, and she felt a sharp pain emitting from her thigh. Oh, right.

She had a giant metal rod jammed in her femur.

She felt a little out of breath as she slowly tried to move each finger, one at a time. She assumed it was most likely because of the fact she also just had a breathing tube down her throat for the past two, three, four hours. Still, something felt off. Who was she kidding? She just woke up from surgery, of course she was going to feel off.

She stamped out the stubborn, nagging voice and concentrated on breathing deeply as she attempted opening her eyes. Her breathing felt shallow, but she ignored it. Her lung was bruised. This was absolutely normal.

She slowly cracked an eye open to her surroundings. She must have been moved back to the room already, as she recognised the beeping of heart monitors and shuffling of other nurses and doctors and patients beyond the curtains. She slowly dragged her gaze down to her legs. There was a single pillow between her

knees and a fresh, nasty looking scar that tore down the side of her right thigh. She grimaced and looked away; she didn't need to see her weaknesses basically imprinted on her body.

Her breaths grew short again as she looked around the room for any distractions. She was glad that at least the pain post-op wasn't too unbearably excruciating. It was toeing the line, but, bearable.

"Oh, Adora, you're awake."

Adora glanced to the side to see her anesthesiologist smiling at her with a clipboard in hand, coming toward her. Adora managed a tight smile back, though the dryness of her throat made her face feel as if it would shrivel up.

"Okay! So the procedure was a success, and we managed to fix you right up! Should be, uh… four to six months before the fracture is fully healed, and we can remove the rod. You'll be able to walk by then, after some physical therapy of course. I'm assuming Catra told you everything, anyway," Scorpia beamed.

"Oh that's-" Adora almost *wheezed*. She cleared her throat and tried again. "That's, uh, fine. Thanks."

"Okay, well, I'll be back in a couple of hours to make sure your pain levels are still down, but Catra will be here in a second to check on you," Scorpia smiled one last time, before waving and walking away.

Adora cursed herself inwardly for not asking for water. Her throat felt dried up as the Crimson Wastes at this point.

As Adora waited for Catra's arrival, she couldn't help but feel insanely bored. She knew she had her phone, but it was probably dead by now, and she really didn't feel like unplugging someone's life support for a round or two of Subway Surfers.

Even then, in her post-operative state, she again yearned some form of physicality. Oh, when was the last time she had a good

spar? It certainly felt like months, anyway. She wondered if Catra sparred…

"Grayskull," her voice called out as she walked into view. Adora tried to at least have some *shame* in staring at her supervising doctor the whole eight seconds it took her to walk to her bed, but couldn't find it in herself to. "How're you holding up?"

"Bored. So bored. Please fight me," Adora said, and she *herself* couldn't tell if she was joking or not. Apparently, that didn't matter, because in the next second she was coughing and coughing again until there was no air left in her lungs.

"Sorry, princess, afraid not. I know you'd win, and I don't think my ego could handle that right now," Catra smirked, already grabbing a stethoscope. Adora sputtered again as she tried to catch her breath.

"*Princess*?"

Catra laughed again, and *god*, Adora would sever off a finger to hear that sound.

"C'mon, blonde hair, blue eyes, sits around on a bed all day. You're name is *Adora*," Catra listed off.

"Well, I can't exactly start bouncing around on the beds, can I?" Adora rolled her eyes, gesturing her very much unusable leg.

"Not with that attitude you can't," Catra said matter-of-factly. "Now turn over to your side, *princess*."

Grumbling, and with probably more struggle than she's ever had, she turned herself over. Her bad ribs were facing up, as well as her surgery scar. And her face, of course, was facing away from Catra.

"I'm going to check your breathing, 'kay?"

Adora nodded, and shivered as the freezing cold surface of the stethoscope made contact with her back.

"Breathe in and out deeply for me."

For me

Adora, focus!

Adora tried to draw in as deep a breath as she could muster, but they were quick-paced and short. She could practically feel Catra's eye lasers burning into the back of her neck.

"Again."

So, it continued. Her breaths were short and shallow as Catra moved the stethoscope up and down her back. Adora could care less about her shriveling lungs as her heart thumped loudly each time Catra's warm fingertips lingered on her skin. She finally pulled back, sighing heavily. Whatever small hope Adora thought she had shattered with the breath.

"Okay, I'm booking you in for an x-ray tomorrow. It's a little soon, but if we don't find out soon, then…"

"But, it could just be nothing, right?" Adora asked, struggling back onto her back. Catra looked away regretfully, shattering Adora once again.

"I wouldn't hold my breath, Grayskull."

"…You've got a twisted sense of humour, you know that?"

-

"Okay, hold your breath for a few seconds, alright? Don't move."

Adora laid face-down on a different bed in the radiographic imaging room, trying her best to be completely still. Even if she couldn't move from a bed, she would fidget with whatever was

available; a loose thread, a funny texture. Absolute stillness was not a skill she had mastered.

An unknown machine behind her whirred and buzzed for a few seconds as it took her x-ray. When the sound paused, Adora heard the door open a few seconds later, and Catra came into the room.

“Shouldn’t there be a pulmonologist here or something?” Adora asked, slightly muffled.

“Wow, you’re right,” Catra said, before helping to flip her back over (much to Adora’s embarrassment). “Nice to meet you, I’m Catra. I’ll be your pulmonologist during your stay at Brightmoon Healthcare Centre.”

“Oh.”

Catra shook her head slightly, laughing.

“Okay, I’ll need to check the results, but I’ll let you know what’s up in a few minutes.”

Adora nodded before she was wheeled away by an unfamiliar doctor, back to the boring, bland ward. And she waited. If Adora didn’t die from complications in this place, she certainly would of boredom. Unplugging that important-looking cable to charge her phone suddenly felt very tempting. She shook the thought from her head and patiently waited twelve eternities for Catra to come back.

When she did, though, her expression was enough to make Adora want to jump up and hobble her way home. Catra cleared her throat before speaking.

“So, bad news, princess.”

Chapter End Notes

thank u for all the support so far i hope u like it:)

p.s. lmk if u want to see a catra pov:)

Chapter 4

Chapter Notes

heyy, im going to post another chapter today bc i wont be able to tomorrow:))
holy crap people

600 hits???? FGHJKLHJGV
thank you all so so so so SO much for reading, leaving kudos and comments, it really motivates me writing each chapter:)

anyway, heres a chapter in catras pov, i hope u like it:))

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Have you heard of acute respiratory distress syndrome?"

"Uh, no."

Catra stared into space sitting at the breakroom table, tracing and tapping uneven patterns into the thin wood as she replayed their conversation over and over in her head.

"It can result from infection or injury," she explained, heart already splitting for the woman. "It occurs when fluid builds up in these tiny, elastic air sacs in your lungs. The fluid keeps your lungs from filling with enough air, which means less oxygen reaches your bloodstream, which that can deprive your other organs of enough oxygen.

"There are three stages; exudative, proliferative and fibrosis. We'll have to check the severity by degree of hypoxemia, which will require a blood test. Good news, the accident was only four days ago, there's a higher chance of only being in the exudative stage. Bad news, ARDS can worsen rapidly. You will most likely have to be put on a ventilator, and possibly placed in our ICU if it worsens."

Each word that left her mouth looked as though they were burning holes in Adora's soul. Her eyes had looked duller and duller at each term Catra threw out into the open.

"…*unfortunately, there is no cure as of*…"

"…*risk of mortality*…"

"…*ECMO procedures are sometimes*…"

Catra knew Adora probably wasn't going to die. There was a sixty to seventy-five percentage chance of her survival. She usually wouldn't be so optimistic for her patients when there was a risk of mortality involved, but it was… *different* with Adora.

She was an exciting woman. Catra doesn't remember ever bantering or laughing with a patient like she did with her. Of course, she had heard of her soccer team captaincy before the accident. The odd time she was so bored and reduced to watching sports on the tv, the built blonde certainly caught her eye over the others.

It was hard to remain completely professional around her. She'd already found out how Adora was easily flustered, and would be lying if she said she didn't just revel in the feeling of teasing the woman. Catra even hoped after she got better, maybe in a few weeks, she could ask her out. She couldn't as of now, for obvious reasons.

She was going to be Adora's doctor for much longer than she had hoped. With Adora's condition, if they started dating now and she *died-*

Catra shook her head and realised her nails were dug into the table. She relaxed her hand and took a quite aggressive sip of the bitter coffee in front of her. Try as she might, she had already set herself up for getting hurt. She was Adora's pulmonologist, and the woman had ARDS. Her life was in Catra's hands.

Adora's not going to die.

Sure, ARDS is a common cause of respiratory failure, but only in critically ill patients.

You're fault.

Okay, the disease can worsen quicker than anyone can expect. And fine, if Catra doesn't look after her properly her organs could fail from lack of oxygen and that can lead to heart failure.

You're fault.

Alright, respiratory arrest is a very real threat that can lead to cardiac arrest and Adora's inevitable death which would be Catra's fault for occurring from the lack of proper attention and precision of those godforsaken procedures, but…

You're fau-

"Wildcat? You look like you've seen a ghost."

Catra snapped out of her spiral, looking up to see Scorpia sitting down across from her.

"Adora's-," she replied almost absent-mindedly. She bit back the rest of her sentence, afraid if she said the fact out loud it would somehow make everything feel more real than it already did. "Not well," she decided on instead.

"Oh my gosh, Wildcat, sorry," Scorpia gasped, placing a hand on Catra's shoulder briefly. "I know you're… fond of her."

The brunette's head snapped up at that, ignoring the light heat that formed on her cheeks. Scorpia immediately backtracked, holding her hands up defensively.

"I-I just mean you've been… I don't know, you just look happier every time you walk out of that ward." She tried to word her message carefully, not wanting to startle her best friend with the truth that everyone around her except Catra knew.

“Yeah, well, she’s-” Ridiculous. Cute. Funny. Heart-stoppingly brain-numbingly drop-dead gorgeous, the way her face lights up around others, the way she manages to find a way to be attractive even when she’s bruised and broken in a bed all day, how she sputters for a response at every teasing comment from Catra. “I haven’t met anyone like her before,” she settled on quietly, taking another sip from her coffee.

The look on Scorpia’s face was a mix of happiness from her friend, and regret for her. She knew Catra was getting too attached. *Catra* knew she was getting too attached. It was never a very wise idea to befriend, bond with or grow fond of patients. That’s what happens; you meet, things go well, then they’re not. And *just* when you think things are looking up, they die.

Catra could only hope that wasn’t going to be the case with Adora.

-

The rest of Catra’s day droned on and on as she waited for the minute she could go and check on Adora. Her day wasn’t busy, she only had a few biopsies and angiograms to carry out. She couldn’t help but think of the blonde woman waiting for her in another ward each time she tended to a different patient. When she was finally done and it was time to check on Adora, she shamelessly almost sprinted down the corridor and down the stairs until she reached the ward, making sure to make her pace seem casual before walking up to her bed.

“Hey, Adora,” Catra pursed her lips into a small smile, eyeing the slightly dejected-looking woman. She tried not to melt into a bubbling, gay puddle as she noticed Adora perk up slightly at her arrival, a small smile tugging at her lips.

“What happened to princess?” She raised an eyebrow.

“Oh forgive me,” Catra said extra dramatically, adding a small, terribly-postured curtsy before picking up a thermometer. “So,

how are you?”

“Never better,” Adora beamed tiredly, and Catra’s heart ached for her. She just wanted to hold her close and whisper into her ear that things would be alright and she would never let anything happen to her ever again-

You’re at work, idiot.

This is your job.

She is your patient.

“I actually have a question,” Adora said as Catra hovered the thermometer in front of her perfect, pink lips. She braced herself, ready to be hit with the usual questions that came with patients in danger of fatality.

“Can I see my friends? Y’know, in case,” she gestured her mouth, indicating her chances of being hooked up to a ventilator.

“Oh,” she replied, again finding herself wanting to cry for the woman. “Sure, I’ll see what I can do. Open.”

Adora smiled at her gratefully before taking the stick in her mouth. For the rest of their time together, Catra made sure to talk to Adora as much as she possibly could, savoring each delicious moment the blonde opened her mouth.

There was still a voice in the back of her mind, screaming and pleading with her to detach whatever was there. Her future self might loath her for disobeying, but she wanted Adora’s smile, words, dumb jokes, *everything* for as long as she could hold on to it.

Catra didn’t want to believe it was all in her hands, to crumble, or thrive.

Chapter End Notes

wow im so ominous

is anyone else concerned by their spotify wrapped? my total listening time is 19 days straight but anyway-

kudos and comments make my world spin around, thanks for all ur support and i hope u liked this one<3

Chapter 5

Chapter Notes

> just to say, catra in this specialises in cardiopulmonology, if u dont know thats heart & lung stuff. anyway
>
> 100 kudos?? guys i was screeeeeeeaming let me tell you
> heres more drama because i am evil and these lesbians dont suffer enough quite yet
> jkjk
>
> ENJOY I LOVE YOU

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Chief's coming in today," Scorpia sighed, nudging a half-asleep Catra. The woman groaned in return, rubbing the exhaustion from her eyes with the back of her hand.

"That bastard sure has some great fucking timing. I swear he's out to get me," she complained. Her week already hadn't been easy, with the added stress of her self-sabotaging friendship with Adora on top of all of her other patients, her hours were longer and she often found herself tossing and turning instead of getting enough valuable sleep.

No doctor or nurse at Brightmoon was especially fond of the chief. They had good reason, too; he swung in whenever he wanted, to make sure things were 'going smoothly.' It wasn't unusual for him to threaten some of his workers with unemployment if things weren't going to his exact, unreasonable, pristine standards.

Catra had her fair share of interactions with the unpleasant man. Nobody could really tell if he liked anyone or not; his words were something one could describe as almost kindness, supportiveness even. But his tone, however, made even the sweetest of statements seem sinister. It was rare, but not unheard of for him to even let someone go every once in a while, if they 'failed him.'

That was another thing about the chief. He wanted the hospital to run like clockwork, every finger and toe perfectly in line. His idea of 'perfection' consisted of every one of his employees wandering around like mindless zombies who's only purpose in life was to work there. He was big on his *rules*.

Which was unfortunate for Catra, since one of those most established rules was to keep the doctor-patient relationships strictly professional. Of course it was for the money and power he could continue to withhold, being a firm believer in the fact that any emotional involvement with patients would lead to lack of absolute focus and precision. With that would come mistakes, god forbid, and mistakes mean failure, and failure means unemployment. It's a toxic cycle, really.

"C'mon, that's not true," Scorpia tried for a smile. Catra gave her a side-glance at the blatant lie. "He called you one of his 'prized possessions' last visit?" Catra had to gag at the memory.

"Yeah, because this job is all I have, Scorp, you know that. And if keeping it means sucking up to that blood-sucking, slithering robot, so be it."

She caught Scorpia's expression, and knew she didn't believe Catra really 'sucked up' to the chief. Sure, she was what one could call polite, if you squinted, but whenever he wasn't within a ten-foot radius she would be cursing him under her breath. Or maybe a little louder than what a standard inside-voice could be considered.

Catra clutched her clipboard a little harder as the two continued walking down the hallway, dodging the odd bed being wheeled from room to room.

"Okay, I'm off to the delivery room," Scorpia indicated a long corridor to their left. "Catch you later, Wildcat!"

"Later," Catra gave a small wave before just making the closing elevator. It opened again with a ding onto a higher floor. She

glanced at her clipboard as she started down the hallway, reading the patients name '*Laurence Adams - due for discharge post MI*.'

Now, if she could only smooth through her day without any run-ins with the chief, finished up with her patient quick enough, she might be able to see Adora quicker than she was supposed to. She realised she was coming up to her ward then, and recognised two faces that stood outside. It was Sparkles and Arrow - Adora's friends, she remembered. The ones that darted past her to the ward after the explicitly told them the woman wasn't fit for visitors.

Except, something was wrong. Glitter was wrapped up in Croptop's arms, with her hands over her face. Her frame was convulsing; she looked like she was sobbing. Her pace slowed to a stop, and she realised she had carried herself over to the two.

"Um," she said awkwardly, and the two looked up at her. Catra mentally groaned, she really wasn't one to deal with emotions, let alone her own, but others? "I'm Adora's pulmonologist and supervising doctor, and I believe we've met. My name is-"

"Doctor D'riluth?"

Catra felt her hackles rising, instantly recognising the voice. It was all too familiar - deep and honeyed, almost mocking in a sense. She turned around and craned her neck to look at the chief.

"Prime," she spoke as calmly as she could force herself. "Always a pleasure."

"Likewise," he smiled eerily. "I am just here to ensure things are proceeding as how they should be."

"Of course, sir," Catra glanced down at her clipboard again. "I was just on my way to general." Prime glanced through the window of the ward next to them, before leaning back again.

"This seems to be the surgical intensive care unit," he remarked, casting a quick glance to Glimmer and Bow. "On your way, doctor."

With that, he turned and strode back down the hallway, peering closely at each of his nervous employees. Catra dragged a hand down her face before turning back to the two. The man looked shaken up, a little more than his shorter companion.

"She's going to be okay, right?" Arrow asked, hugging Shimmer closer to his chest.

"Yeah. Yeah, I'm sure she'll be fine," Catra replied, not entirely sure who she was trying to convince in this conversation. "I, um, I have to go."

And with that, she sped off down the hallway, not quite hearing whatever they called after her. She hardly even realised when she reached the general ward, and she found her feet carrying her to Laurence's bed.

"Sir," she greeted, already pulling the stethoscope that forever lived around her neck off. She tried to do things fast and efficient; it always felt as though the chief had eyes and ears everywhere. It was creepy.

"How're you feeling? Ready to go?" She asked as she listened to the elderly man's heartbeat.

"No," he wheezed, swatting her away. "I like it here. Sleep all day, food brought to me, no darn Becky tryna git me to do no more chores."

Don't laugh at the poor old man, Catra. That's rude.

"I'm sure Becky will understand you have to take it easy from now on, sir. It's time to go home now."

"Yeah, yeah," he sighed, allowing Catra to help him up by his forearms. "She better not be s'pecin' me to do those damn dishers," he mumbled under his breath. At that moment, the door burst open and in rushed who Catra assumed was Becky.

"Laurie!"

She hobbled over to him as fast as her old-lady legs would carry her, and they shared a hug. Catra couldn't help but feel like she was intruding, before Laurence turned back to her.

"This fine young woman here's been takin' good care of me," he announced. Catra pursed her lips into a smile as Becky started to fuss over her, grabbing her into a hug.

"Bless your heart, darlin'. Bless you," she praised, releasing her finally. "You take good care of yourself now, y'hear? I know everyone here's lucky to have you."

"Thank you, Mrs. Adams," she replied. As she watched the couple retreat from the ward, she couldn't help but let her mind wander. It must be nice to have somebody to grow old with like that. She left the ward blankly, heading back down the corridor and along to Adora's ward.

That was when her mood shifted. Sooner rather than later, she was either to redeem Adora fit to continue with her recovery, or to commence more procedures it broke her heart to do. The woman would be one step closer to discharge planning, or the unthinkable.

She finally stepped inside, almost yelling out in frustration when she saw Prime wandering up and down the room, inspecting conditions, procedures, work efforts. Fortunately, it didn't look like the chief had reached her yet. He was still stalking two curtains down.

"Hey, Adora," Catra said, but her usual greeting lacked the teasing and slightly flirty tone. The last thing she needed was for Prime to overhear her, and get suspicious.

"Catra," Adora smiled, and her heart just melted. She had to keep a straight face, before she accidently slipped into their easy, usual back-and-forth.

"So, you're rib surgery is still queued up, but we can't do anything until we know how things are. I'll bring you in for a CT scan to

your chest, then we can be sure of what's going on," Catra tried to keep on her best doctor's voice, and stared lasers into her clipboard because she knew she wouldn't be able to keep up the facade if she even caught a glimpse of Adora's face.

"Rest up," was the last thing she said before walking away, painfully ignoring Adora's quiet '*Wait*.' Before she could scurry out of the ward and distract herself with more work, she felt a tight grasp on her shoulder. It was Prime's hand - like cold metal, his fingers like knives.

"I can gather your very professional in interactions with your patients, Doctor D'riluth," he said calmly.

"Of course," Catra replied, stomach twisting into knots. "Why wouldn't I?"

His grip tightened for a quarter of a millisecond before he released her, humming his response. Catra nodded a goodbye quickly, before making a beeline for the door as casually as she could, leaving the ward in the dust.

Leaving Adora in the dust.

Chapter End Notes

guys im sorry i added prime okay? apparently adora almost dying isnt enough for my empty soul

if youre reading these chapters all in one go right now, GO AND DRINK SOME WATER
i know what time it is. turn off your phone and GO THE FUCK TO SLEEP
im watching you

i love you thank you so sososososo much for making it this far, leave kudos and a comment if you enjoyed! :)

Chapter 6

Chapter Notes

hey so this chapter is a lil shorter, just to fill in whats up with our favourite blonde

also
1k HITS???? GUYSSS
no words honestly, but thank you all so much for reading it means so so much to me you dpnt even know

finally, shoutout to ya_girl_Static for getting 148k mins listening time on spotify???? consider me impressed and very scared

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora's eyes shot left to right and any other direction they could as the radiographer strapped her head down, desperately trying to take in her surroundings. It was much like the rets of the hospital; white, tiled ceilings, smoke alarms, the odd sad-looking plant pot housing a faux yucca plant to make the place seem 'homier'.

One arm was placed by her side as her other was enclosed still in a cast, and her legs were laid straight out. Even with her loosely-fitted hospital-issued gown she felt as though she was tightly trapped binds and held in a coffin.

"Okay!" The radiographer clapped her hands together, purple hair swaying by her elbows. She made Adora feel more comforted than anything with her excitement and utter sureness as she fondly placed a hand on the CT scanner. "This is Emily! She should take less than thirty minutes. She's good like that. You need to try breathe as deeply as possible, and hold your breath if I say so."

Adora nodded as best she could with her head strapped down, not quite finding the strength to speak her confirmation in her position. Her breathing felt strained as ever, if not worse; she

could feel herself getting weaker by the hour. Not that she would ever admit it, though, she was still going to keep going. She could run on empty. Piece of *cake*.

The lively radiographer bounced away into the control room, behind the protection of a glass screen. She hit some controls before the large machine Adora was placed on started whirring and buzzing and jolted as it slowly pulled her into the pristine, solitary confinement.

The minutes passed like decades, and Adora was itching to move any muscle. She tried to focus very hard on her breathing, in and out, and holding it for a few seconds occasionally at the radiographer's command. It was harder than it should've been - she could hear the low wheezes she released with each breath, and she could sense how quickly she was inhaling.

There was something wrong, she knew that. She wasn't naive. She just hoped that it wouldn't be the absolute worst case scenario, which the probability of that wasn't a ridiculous low.

What she had recently learned during her hours in that godforsaken bed, is that silence and nothingness gets her nowhere but the memories she wants to forget. Of course, her mind would betray her, anyway. Try as she might, well, maybe she didn't try *that* hard, her thoughts wandered to Catra.

The day previous had been a strange one, to say the least. Some strange but important-looking man was stalking the corridors, she could see him going up and down through the door windows, until her finally entered her ward. She assumed he must have been the boss or something, and a scary one at that, not just from the way he held himself like he owned the place but the general change in atmosphere and tenseness that fell upon the room when he came in.

The doctors and nurses were scurrying fast around everywhere, trying to do things quickly by the looks of things. Adora noticed how any unlucky soul who happened to fall under his frightening

glare would pick their pace up, work in silence and more depth than what was probably necessary.

They all acted weird, too. Including Catra.

She didn't explicitly ask how Adora was like she usually did. Her voice was flat and didn't hold her usual playful tone that made Adora's stomach feel like it was going to fall out of her butt. There was no banter, no teasing, no nicknames.

Well, Adora supposed that was her job anyway. What would make her more special than any other patient? She had painfully realised that whatever bond or dare she say *friendship* she thought she held with Catra was obviously one-sided, and the doctor had finally come to her senses that she would be much better off being around people who weren't rotting away in a hospital-

Adora cut herself off.

Think of something else. Anything.

She tried to focus on keeping her breath from losing its steady-ish rhythm she worked up to, and casted her gaze to the piece of machinery whirring above her. It moved from her neck to her midsection and back again in a slow pattern.

"Okay, she's all done!" The sound of the radiographer's voice rang slightly muffled in Adora's ear. "Bringing you out, now."

Surely enough, a few seconds later the whirring stopped, replaced by a buzzing and she was slowly brought out of her pristine, white prison. The sound of the creaky door handle turning open from the control room echoed, before the woman came out and unstrapped Adora's head. Adora then sat up on her own; she was more than a little out of breath, and winced in pain from her still-healing ribs, but was proud she could do at least that. She tried not to think about how pathetic that was on her part.

“Alrighty, someone should be here to bring you back down in a sec. I’ll have your results for you after consulting with my assistant,” she said, already eagerly heading back to the control room to review the images. Adora couldn’t tell if she nodded or the world was starting to spin.

Wait.

The world isn’t supposed to spin like this, is it?

Adora found herself suddenly light-headed, desperately taking in shallow breaths as much as she could. Her mind started to go fuzzy, and the sounds around her sounded underwater. The all too sickeningly familiar scenario started to play out around her, again.

She felt her back connect with something soft.

“*Adora*!”

No, no, no, not again, not again.

“*It’s developed to fibrotic, she’s not going to-*”

Her eyes were prised open, more lights. So many *lights*.

“*She needs a ventilator, go,* go!”

She tried to open her eyes, but her vision went in and out. Everything was moving, the ceiling was falling slowly behind her. There was something on her face, what was it?

Someone leaned over her, a face… Catra’s face? Why was Catra here? What was she doing?

The face disappeared, and the world shut out soon after.

Chapter End Notes

> dont bite me for this im sorry, our girls on life support now there was no prime today, but mark my words yall aint safe

kudos and comments make me happy
very happy

drink some water or i will take your kneecaps :))

edit: hey guys life is kicking my ass pretty bad rn, i promise to post a new chapter by wednesday or thursday at latest.
sorry and i hope you understand
love u thank u bye <33

Chapter 7

Chapter Notes

HEY GUYSSSSSS

im so sorry for not updating in a hot minute, but life's kicking my ass rn lmao im pretty sure all my friends hate me but anyway

TAHNK YOU FOR REAIDNG I LOVE YOU ALL SM ENJOY

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra wasn't really known for being extra emotional after every case of bad news.

Not that she didn't care about her patients. But bad news was part of her job, her almost every day life. The prospect was almost cruel if she thought about it too much, with the fact of having to accept that sometimes patients die, sometimes they just don't wake up. But, she had to persevere. All of them had to persevere. No matter how hard it was to move on to one person from the next after another tragedy, it was still and always would be a part of her job.

It never got easier. She didn't believe it ever would. She managed to master the skill of forever plastering her 'resting bitch' expression even after the most heartbreaking situations she walked out of. There was enough wrong in the world to keep her distracted throughout the day; shootings, stabbings, a steady flow of crack addicts, her own *chief*.

That was just how life went. At the end of the day the world was still spinning and the sun kept shining.

So why was it so different with Adora?

Catra hardly knew the woman. Well, she knew some things, the basics. Hobbies, interests, nothing more than what she needed to know as a doctor and slightly extra. For… work related reasons. Only. Right.

But it wasn't *enough*. And it wasn't going to be for who knows how long she'll be on the damn vent, too. Maybe it wouldn't be so bad if Catra could control her own feet for once, as she once again found herself standing outside the ICU at the half-conscious blonde. It was self-sabotage, that was one fact that played over and over in her head non-stop every time she caught another glimpse of the woman laying motionless on a thin mattress with the vent tube down her throat.

Did she listen to herself?

Pssh.

Catra jumped as she felt a hand on her shoulder. She loosened her way-too-tight grip on her clipboard and dragged her gaze away from the door to Perfuma. She had to bite back a groan - Perfuma was the psychiatric attending at Brightmoon, and took her job very seriously. Her counselling services even extended to the staff a lot of the time, and she was one of the only people who really recognised the fact that the doctors and nurses' lives weren't all sunshine. Especially when a patient didn't survive their procedures, she would always manage to find one way or another to rope them in for a healthy talk-out. She hadn't quite managed to get Catra yet, though. And she wasn't about to crumble just because she had a little crush on that big, dumb, gorgeous -

Catra mentally slapped herself. She did not have a *crush*. She hadn't sunken that low, not yet.

"Catra," Perfuma's forever calm voice snapped her out of her thoughts. There was a soft smile on her face and her wavy, blonde hair was cascading around her upper arms. "How are you doing?"

“Fine,” Catra said after clearing her throat, crossing her arms loosely across her chest. Her eyes darted between the woman in front of her and through the glass on the door to the ICU she so desperately craved to be in right now.

“Hm,” Perfuma replied, noticing the brief movement. “Is your patient in there?”

“Yeah. She’s, uh,” Catra gulped, swaying her arm uselessly at the door as if it would answer anything. “On the vent.”

Perfuma nodded but kept her soft gaze, laced with concern, firmly on Catra. Catra hated the way she had some sort of telepathic powers that made her feel like she had everything that was whirring around in her mind written on her face every time Perfuma glanced at her.

“I see. It’s difficult to watch people we are close with suffer, especially with not being able to predict the outcome.”

“Woah, hey,” Catra threw her hands up defensively. “She’s only my patient. We aren’t… *close*.” She practically spat out the last word, voice hardly above a whisper.

“Okay, well,” the taller woman smiled, bringing her hands together. “If you ever need to talk, as always, my offer still stands.”

“Thanks, um,” Catra started awkwardly, scratching her brow. “I don’t think so. I gotta go, see you around.”

She finally stepped away, and started heading back down the corridor and into the elevator. She was so lost in thought over everything - was Adora going to get better? Why did she care so much? She shouldn’t. Was it really that obvious she maybe *sort of* favoured her over the other patients? Well, come on. Who wouldn’t? Was it obvious, or was there something in all that green tea Perfuma drank? - she didn’t even notice when the door pinged open to a familiar face.

“Catra, god, finally,” Mermista sighed, grabbing her wrist and dragging her out of the elevator. “Where the hell have you been?”

“Around,” Catra replied, yanking her arm back and following the woman storming down the bleach-scented corridor. “Miss me?”

“Uh huh,” Mermista scoffed, turning a sharp corner and into a room. There was a middle aged woman laid on the bed, arms crossed and audibly wheezing. Mermista thrust a second clipboard into Catra’s arms as she waited impatiently for her to flick through the symptoms.

“Chest pain, weakness, nausea, shortness of breath. And a smoker,” Catra sighed, looking up from the summary at the grumpy woman. “Sounds like CAD. Line her up for a CT, she’ll probably need surgery. Come find me when you get the results.”

The woman wheezed, glaring at Catra judgingly. It took all of Catra’s willpower to not scowl at her back.

“Thanks, Kitty,” Mermista smirked as the woman almost hurled the clipboard back at her before stomping out. She forced a few deep breaths into her lungs as she tried to snap out of whatever headspace she found herself in suddenly.

Alright, this was *ridiculous*. Catra was on edge a lot of the time, most shifts. But not *this* bad. She was almost temped to nick a cigarette off Perfuma, she knew she always had them handy for especially bad days. Catra laughed a little at the thought of the irony.

“Something funny, doctor?”

Catra almost yelped at the sound, turning around quickly to face… the chief?

Oh, hell no.

“P-Prime? Uh, back so soon?” She gulped as she watched his beady green eyes scanned her form suspiciously.

“Indeed,” he sighed. “It seems money is getting… tight. Just here to review some things, see what can be done.”

“Sir?” Catra asked, already scolding herself internally.

“Seeing of what equipment is unneeded, doctor. Extra medications, some procedures perhaps. No use in using up our resources for lost causes, shall we say?”

Prime must have noticed the slightly horrified look on his employee’s face, but he laughed it off darkly.

“Forgive me for my choice of wording. I mean to say useless procedures on those who are dead and such like that shall be cut down. I am no monster. Right then, as you were.”

Catra tried to relax her expression as she swallowed the bile rising in her throat, giving her chief a brief nod and turning away.

She strode down the corridor, not quite sure where she was going.

Well, maybe she did.

Chapter End Notes

is that foreshadowing i smell?

GO AND DRINK SOME WATER U DEHYDRATED SMEXY BITCH

leave kudos and comments to fill the empty void in my soul :D

Chapter 8

Chapter Notes

hello beautiful human

omg im ngl, i regret a lot of decisions so far in this fic. i feel like it couldve gone a lot of better ways (plot wise) but reading ur comments definitely make me think different of it:)

i spent like an almost three hrs sorting out where i wanted this to go and managed to split it into 18 chapters as u saw, so yeah:)

thank you so much for being here <3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra leaned herself on her forearms against the front desk of the hospital, flicking through a stack of more tedious paperwork she was left to fill out and verify for another diagnosis. It wasn't the most entertaining task she had been assigned to that day, but it was at least going to carry her over until the shift change in half an hour. She really did try her best to stay alert, but the longer she stared at the sad mountain of papers her eyes grew droopier and more tired and the words started to melt together into blurs of ink.

The whole week she could feel her patience slowly draining from her each time somebody else paged her, patients wouldn't cooperate, even when another emergency incoming rolled in. Of course she didn't want to let anyone suffer or go without attention, only she would just much prefer to curl up on the floor and fall asleep than be responsible for more shit than she already was.

The half filled coffee cup in her hand that was constantly being refilled and providing Catra with temporary energy was doing the job, at least. As much as it kept her awake, she still felt antsy. All

she needed to do for the next half hour was focus, and keep the thin thread holding a meaningless outburst to herself. She narrowed her eyes and kept her thoughts firmly on the objective in front of her.

That was, until, she felt a heavy tap on her shoulder. More of a pat on the back, really. She felt her eye twitch as she slammed the pen on the desk and turned around. She immediately came face-to-face with a slouched over man, one who she recognised all too well. She could already smell the reek of alcohol emitting from his general self, and one glance at his stubbled face and horrifically dark circles around his eyes, she knew what he came for.

"Hey, uh, I've got like, a *killer* headache," he slurred, swaying slightly in his stance. "I was wondering if you had some painkillers or s-"

"Are you *serious* right now?" Catra said, probably louder than necessary. A few heads turned their way, but Catra had already snapped. "Dude, I've seen you wobbling around here before, and I know the night shift have to. People come here if they need emergency medical attention, people *die* here. What do you not *understand*?" A few more people were watching now, and Catra could already see Perfuma stepping closer out of the corner of her eye. She narrowed her glare at the young man standing in front of her.

"'Lright, whatever, *jeeeez*," he replied, throwing his arms up.

"Get your fucking ass *out* of here before I-"

"*Catra*!"

The woman snapped her mouth shut angrily, keeping her glare in front of her while Perfuma stood between the two.

"Sir, if you could please leave the premises immediately," she spoke with an unfamiliar coldness to the man, who was already spinning around to go. "And to not return."

“I was *handling* it,” Catra grumbled through gritted teeth and a clenched jaw after the man retreated the building slowly. Perfuma took a deep breath, moving her hands gracefully as she inhaled and exhaled.

“Catra,” she said calmly but firmly, catching the other woman’s sharp gaze in her own. “I understand that you are under a lot of stress at the moment. I really think it would be beneficial if we just talked-”

“We’re all under stress, Perfuma,” Catra said, looking at the ground. “Look, the shifts are switching soon. I have the day off tomorrow, things will be fine after that. Just drop it, okay?”

The blonde woman sighed, placing a comforting hand on her shoulder, but Catra still didn’t meet her eyes.

“I’m always here.”

With that, she walked away. Catra finally looked up to still see a few heads turned her way, she scowled at the general place, before bounding down the hallway to check on her patient.

-

Catra wouldn’t admit to herself that she would rather spend her whole day by Adora’s side to make sure she was fine.

She already had nurses monitoring her most of the time, and since she was her supervising doctor she knew she would be the first notified if things started going to shit. That didn’t stop her constantly catching herself imagining the worst for her, though.

She stood next to the woman, eyes trained on her peaceful face rather than the monitor, where they probably should have been. The sound of her quiet and a little weak, but *there,* breaths through the tubes and the stable beeping in the background was like music to her ears.

Her condition had worsened, of *course* it had. Catra was an idiot for thinking it wouldn't. And now she was hooked up to a life support machine that was keeping her there. None of this was fair, Adora didn't deserve any of it. All Catra wanted in that moment was to see her lively, crystal blue eyes sparkle in the warm sunlight and listen to her sweet voice ramble and watch her cheeks redden at another tease.

But instead Adora was stuck like this. Pale, unconscious, unmoving.

Catra's eyes stung with angry tears; angry at the universe, angry at whatever asshole landed Adora in that bed in the first place, hell, even angry at herself.

She wasn't allowed to feel like this. She wasn't allowed to care about a patient so much. Her emotions were already clouding her usually perfected, medically professional cardiopulmonologist mindset.

"Hey Adora," she whispered softly to the woman who was ruining her. A single tear rolled down her cheek before she could stop herself, but she quickly caught it.

"You won't believe what just happened," she let out a watery laugh. "I'll tell you about it some time. Um, I won't be in tomorrow. It's fine though, there will still be nurses to check on you."

At this point, the unprofessionalism of the one-sided conversation was the farthest thing from her mind. She would get all the time she could to do this when Prime wasn't around. So, she stayed with Adora a few minutes even after her shift ended, talking about some of her duties she had that day, how the damned ARDS were definitely (*hopefully*) going away. And then, she stood there. For a moment, she reached a hand out to push a strand of hair behind the woman's ear.

You're just asking to be hurt at this point, aren't you?

She drew back her hand as she gave into the raging war of thoughts in her mind. She quickly looked around the room before clenching her fist and leaving that godforsaken unit.

Chapter End Notes

GUYS BTW all these random characters like the addict and that old couple a while ago arent just little blobs of nothingness, i swear theyre all ✨i n v o l v e d ✨in the later plot

please leave kudos and a comment i swear they make me so ridiculously happy to read:))

~ drink the earth juice my children, i will not hesitate to send perfuma after u <3 ~

Chapter 9

Chapter Notes

hello gorgeous creature

ohmygosh, okok. so id just like to say a quick thing before we hop in:)

my original idea for this whole fic was a short little dib dab that i didnt expect to do THIS well. if i had one main goal for any works of mine, it would be to have one of you guys thinking about this during ur day:) comment from poggs on the last chapter, you said u were thinking about it and you honestly dont know how much this means to me. i really have no words but thank you<3

also thank you for all the kind words from everyone else on each chapter, i start smiling like an idiot when i think of them during my day lol<3 im so happy you guys are interested in this, it really means the world to me

OK ENJOY I LOVE YOU THANK YOU!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

When Catra arrived back at the hospital at 8 a.m. on the dot, right on time for her shift, she knew something different was up. She didn't need to drink Perfuma's magical green tea to know the whole vibe was sideways the second she stepped in the doors.

Catra had taken her day off, and, it wasn't as refreshing and completely mind-resetting as she had unrealistically but still majorly hoped it would be. She did not end up sorting out her very much disorganised priorities, nor the tangled mess of knots and thoughts that still plagued her brain. She ended up having a drink or two in the solitary confinement of her home, overlooking the illuminated city of Brightmoon in the middle of the night with

a cigarette guiltily held between her fingers and music blasting in her ears to tune out her too loud thoughts.

Catra knew Brightmoon was a relatively busy establishment. Busy enough as most hospitals were, but it also wasn't the only one around for miles. They lived in a pretty damn big and fancy city, after all. They still had a full enough flow of major trauma victims on a day to day basis, but not as frequently as some of the more isolated hospitals she was familiar with, like in the Crimson Wastes. Patients were always being taken in and discharged every day. The waiting rooms were filled, but not in an overcrowded way. They weren't short-staffed for the most part, if not slightly low on nurses.

So, the increase in staff members overnight was definitely a noticeable change when the extra, maybe ten, men started their jobs out-of-the-blue with no warning. Prime had employed them, that much was obvious. They were so hard working and precise and discreet yet speedy at any task. They were almost clone-like; exactly what Prime wanted in his workers, copy and pasted into human form ten times.

They were all clearly loyal to him, too. Already, nobody had put it past them to not go and snitch on them to the chief on slip ups or lack of absolute efficiency. The nurses especially were more tense as they worked, the masks of black and white and utter neutrality plastered perfectly in place whenever one of them was in the area. They almost seemed to be monitoring things, though they worked side by side. Any doctor or patient who grasped the short end of the stick and would have one accompany them wouldn't be considered the luckiest in any way. They were almost like… mini Primes.

Which was not necessary by any means. Ever since Prime had told Catra about his plans for using up less of their resources, and god forbid the hospital's precious income, he had been showing up more and more often. Peering and inspecting over anyone and everyone's shoulder, advising any suggestions for treatments that

were annoyingly accurate but all the same unasked for seemed to be some of his favorite hobbies as of lately.

Unsurprisingly, he seemed to obviously favor his new employees over the rest. There was no reason for him not to. After all, they obeyed him, never questioned orders (not like the others would so much as think of daring to do so), hovered around like vampires with no other purpose in life than to get whatever task at hand completed.

One thing that definitely got Catra most on edge about them was the fact she had to get used to working by them. She definitely may have jumped a little the first time she saw one already checking up on Adora in her place. Catra felt strangely protective over her at this point, though you couldn't do shit for her to admit that. She didn't want some creepy, foreign, blood sucking clone doing Catra's job to keep Adora safe.

Not that that was her sole purpose for being at the hospital in the first place, anyway.

She would for now ignore the fact that checking up on Adora was the first thing she casually sauntered to after she finished up with her first patient. By the luck of every star that had ever shone, and after verifying her state and breathing and heart rate for what felt like hours, Catra noticed that the vent really was working in getting her back on track. She wouldn't let herself get too excited, though, since the worst case scenario was still a very real threat.

But, still.

Progress.

At least there was that in one aspect of her life. Since her heavily self apathetic affair, she decided to solve all of her problems by simply not. A clever person solves their issues, a wise person avoids them, right?

"Sooo," Scorpia started quietly, swirling one of the only clean spoons that were like gold to find in the breakroom around in her

chamomile tea. Her voice was low enough to be heard by Catra, but only her. “Perfuma and I were wondering if you wanted to come with us to one of those new bars tonight? If you want?”

Catra’s brain was still a little fried from the last night, so she processed Scorpia’s words slowly. Of course it would be nice to go out and get a little wasted with two friends, but she knew she was too mentally exhausted for any sort of excess socialising. Her mental health couldn’t take much more.

Scorpia must have noticed the heavily skeptical look on her friends face, so quickly added, “No job stuff or therapy. Just a couple of gal pals, what d’you say?”

Screw it, since when did Catra ever care about her mental health?

“Sure,” she nodded, her mouth slowly growing into a knowing smirk. “You and Perfuma are getting along, then?”

“Pssh, hah,” Scorpia sputtered, her tea swirling becoming erratic. “I- I mean yeah. She’s so nice, and she’s just…*Stop* looking at me like that, Wildcat!”

Catra just laughed, shaking her head slightly. Teasing Scorpia over her love life was refreshing. The two were made for each other, anyway - Catra definitely called it *ages* ago.

“I’m n-”

THUMP!

Both of their heads snapped to where the sound came from, getting up from their seats quickly and rushing over to the window along with one of the nurses. There were a muffled few cries and screams for help through the glass, and Catra had to press her face against the window to get a look at what had happened, eyes widening when she finally saw it.

“*Shit*.”

Chapter End Notes

heya, juST BTW!

about adora: dont let the info above fool u, its not a definite
YES SHES GETTING BETTER
maybe she will recover
maybe she wont

im so evil wtf

[ps i had to cut out 3 filler chpaters that did nothing for the plot so yh<3]

Chapter 10

Chapter Notes

shits getting sspiiiiiiiiiiiiiiiiiiiiccccccccccccccccccyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyyy

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra enjoyed the adrenaline rush she got from field work.

Even if that field work was just outside the window, the thrill of being on the scene was something she couldn't get from the enclosed wards. The events were quicker paced and definitely more frightening when the patient was in need of immediate medical care in the middle of nowhere; sometimes on the road, ditches, the middle of sidewalks, Catra had seen it all. The hospital grounds at least weren't in the middle of nowhere, because judging by the scene, that probably would not have ended well.

Catra arrived with Scorpia outside in a matter of seconds of sprinting, already finding two of their paramedics. When she was close enough, she fell to her knees by the bundle on the ground. Not much a bundle, it was a person. One of the paramedics, Juliet, gingerly turned them over by their shoulder while the other quickly unzipped an EMT bag.

Catra's eyes went wide as she saw the man's face - the same man who was nagging her for drugs only a few days ago.

"He's got weak respiration," Juliet said, pulling out a bag valve mask and placing it over his mouth and nose, pumping the inflation bag at a steady pace.

"Alright, uh, looks like a lung contusion," Catra breathed, pinching one of his eyes open and flashing her penlight torch at his

abnormal pupil dilation. “Severe brain trauma, get him to trauma one and page Mermista. Scorpia-”

“Got it,” the woman said, rising to her feet and running back inside to grab a dose of morphine.

By now, a stretcher had been layed out next to him. The paramedics loaded him onto it and the three rushed back inside, and into the trauma room, where two nurses and one of Prime’s clones were already waiting. He was swiftly transferred to the bed right when Mermista and Scorpia arrived, the paramedics leaving the room. Scorpia opened up the drawer and took out a hypodermic needle, piercing a small glass bottle and sucking the morphine out of it.

“Isn’t this the guy from the other day?” Mermista asked while she started to unbutton his flannel. “What the hell happened?”

“Fell, or jumped,” Catra replied, swinging her stethoscope off her neck. “Doesn’t matter right now. He’s got a brain injury, he needs a CT.”

“We don’t have *time* for a CT,” Mermista pointed out.

“Then make time, or he’s *going* to die.”

Groaning, Mermista looked from the man, and to the monitor. She finally relented, unclasping the bed’s clamp and handed off the bag valve mask to one of the nurses to continue pumping. Catra moved out of their way as they wheeled the bed down the corridor and into the elevator. The CT could take ten minutes if they really tried, Catra didn’t know if he’d be fine though. Did he really jump? Or did he fall? He seemed pretty wasted already, either way.

It was another twenty minutes before the bed was wheeled back into the room. Catra felt her pager buzz, but ignored it for now and opened her mouth to ask what was up.

“Severe TBI,” Mermista stated before she could ask, sighing as she quickly flicked through a small stack of papers on her clipboard. “Mild pulmonary contusion. We need a ventilator in here, his brain is lacking oxygen.” With that, one of the nurses scurried out with the clone in search of the equipment.

“Prime’s out there, again,” Mermista said dryly, pinching the man’s hand a few times in search of some sort of a response. “Can you hear me? Hello?” She added louder, directed at the patient.

“Of course,” Catra grumbled.

A short while later, the nurse and clone reentered the room with one of the ventilators. Catra grabbed the tube and held his jaw open, carefully sliding it down his air way.

“BP’s picking back up to one twenty over eighty.”

“Keep an eye on him,” Catra said, stepping back as she felt her pager buzz by her side again. “The lung contusion isn’t severe, just keep him on the vent. He’s probaly got a few breaks too, those can be dealt with when he’s stable. Get me if anything else happens.”

“Yes doctor,” Mermista rolled her eyes, shooting her a lazy salute before Catra retreated from the room.

“Doctor D’riluth,” a nurse exclaimed, rushing up to her, panting slightly. “I was sent to find you - did you not get the page?”

“I was busy,” Catra replied, nodding at the door behind which was the unconscious man.

“Right, of course,” the shorter woman breathed out. “It’s just- it’s your patient, Adora Grayskull?”

“What - what happened?” Catra’s mouth moved quicker than her mind, which started to feel like it was collapsing in on itself. She was torn down the middle, one part of her sick to the stomach in confusion, the other screaming ‘*I told you so!*’

“We - we’re not sure. Her BP and respiration rate is falling. She needs your attention ASAP, we’re concerned she could be going into respiratory arrest soon.”

“She *what*? What about the v-”

“Doctor D’riluth!”

Her head snapped to the voice calling her name, it was a different nurse sticking her head out of the door to the room she had just left.

“He’s seizing, Doctor Salineas needs you in here, *now*.”

“I can’t,” she called back, feeling her heartbeat pick up and the bad kind of butterflies in her stomach.

“Is there an issue here?”

Prime.

“Yes,” Catra exclaimed, meeting his eyes with her own. “I’ve got to get up to the ICU, if you’ll excuse me.”

“I believe you have a duty that is in need of fulfilling right here, doctor.”

“No, but,” she began frantically, feeling herself growing increasingly angry at the man towering over her small frame. “She’s my patient, she’s in critical condition and won’t survive if I don’t-”

“Doctor,” Prime cut her off sternly. “That man is also your patient, is he not? Is he too not in critical condition?”

“But-”

“I can send another doctor up to check on miss Grayskull. Anybody qualified in the establishment can handle a crash, but

your *specific* assistance and knowledge is needed with that man in that room, right now.”

“I-”

“Doctor D’riluth we really need you in here!”

“*Fuck*,” Catra borderline yelled, not caring how loudly she just swore in front of the chief. The shorter nurse ran back down the corridor, snatching her pager in the process. Catra turned around on her heels, storming back into the room.

They wanted her to help him?

She’ll fucking help him.

She had to, and if it was her only chance to see Adora again, so be it.

Chapter End Notes

heh... heh.

intense drums kick in
sorry not sorry

comments and kudos are my food and water :)

Chapter 11

Chapter Notes

writers block is my least favourite flavour

guys please tell me in the comments on a scale from 1-10 how mad you would be if there was no kiss at the end:)

(sunds so evil, im just trying to think of a closing scene that isnt a cheap rip off dont hate me)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"What the hell happened?" Catra fumed, storming into the room and slamming the door behind her. She snatched the inflation bag off the nurse, eyes darting to the left to glare at the monitor showcasing his dropping oxygen levels. Beneath her hand the man convulsed and spasmed in the bed. "I hardly left for two fucking minutes."

"Dosing two point five midazolam for seizure prophylaxis now," Scorpia stated, holding his arm down as best as she could keep him still before injecting another dosage of liquid into his vein.

"I think it could be cerebral venous sinus thrombosis," Mermista replied. "I don't know - his head got a pretty big thwack. He'll probably need a craniotomy, I can page Doctor Miller."

"No, don't," Catra interrupted, holding up a hand and pausing Mermista from grabbing her pager from her side. "He could've seized from brain scarring, right? Plus, he was pretty wasted last time I saw him, and I'm assuming isn't clean now."

"Okay, and? What are you saying?"

"I'm *saying*, that high fever," Catra indicated his 102 degrees fever, blue against black on the monitor. "Lack of sleep, fatigue, drug and alcohol use? They all increase the chanced of seizing after a

TBI like this. I still don't know if he's good up there, but I'm guessing there's no need for surgery judging the circumstances. I'm not a neurologist. You think you can handle yourselves without me now, then?" Catra was already backing up slowly for the door, her one goal racing through her mind, begging to be achieved.

"You can't just *leave* now," Mermista exclaimed, taking the inflation bag that had been neglected briefly since Catra had stepped away. The man's body stopped twitching and convulsing in the space of a few seconds, the magical effects of the midazolam already having kicked in. "We're not done treating him."

"I'm not a neurologist, Mermista," Catra repeated as she narrowed her eyes at the woman, wanting nothing more than to dart from the slightly dimly lit room and leg it down to their intensive care unit. "Just page Miller, it'll be fine."

"No, it won't be fine," Catra could see the woman's temper quickly bubbling up and whatever was left of her patience was evaporating into the already too tense atmosphere. "You're still needed here, right now. This man in unconscious, in a state. We don't even know if he'll wake up!"

"*Exactly*," Catra growled, her temper having poured over at this point. She pointed sharply at the monitor, but kept her glare firmly on Mermista. "His stats are *ridiculous*." She stepped an inch closer, grabbing his hand and pinching the skin. Mermista opened her mouth to protest, but was cut off. "He is unresponsive to pain. For all we know he could be fucking brain dead the *second* he hit the fucking ground. You don't need me here to keep him alive."

"But you *just* said–"

"Doesn't matter," Catra snapped, folding her arms condescendingly. "Think you can handle this by yourself, or not?"

"And what is that supposed to mean?" Mermista's eyes narrowed and she stepped closer to the other woman.

"Guys," Scorpia interjected firmly, a foreign expression of frustration replacing her usually joyful ease. "Arguing is really not going to help in this situation. Mermista is right, Wildcat. You can't leave now, not before we figure out what is going on, anyway, okay?"

Catra's glare wavered for a second at her friend's harshness - if Scorpia was getting riled up, she was definitely screwing up bad - before melting away into a tired annoyance as she sighed in defeat. She knew her emotions at this point had gone above and beyond clouding her already fogged up judgement, and it was starting to show. Well, maybe it had already started. Except, this time was different, because Adora was dying for all she knew, and at this point she had probably exceeded the line between caring about a patient, and going clinically fucking insane. She was going insane. And it was all stupid, gorgeous blonde's fault.

"Whatever," she grumbled, lifting her clipboard up to examine the pages with unnecessary detail so she didn't have to face a smug Mermista, who had of course come out of the conversation victorious.

Catra, Scorpia and Mermista spent just the next half of an hour - much to Catra's relief - working on the man. They ran tests - running over the CT scanner results, trying to make sense and match them up with his motor function, sensory function, eye movement, reflexes. It wasn't much of a struggle, mostly thanks to Catra's rather suspicious and out of the blue enthusiastic motivation to figure everything out, right there and right *then*. Not that anybody was complaining, anyway.

The man was still unconscious by the time they had been almost finished. The three decided it would be best to page Doctor Miller to schedule for an immediate ICP measurement, which they collectively agreed would be the safest bet with monitoring his state with that cornerstone procedure when it can to more severe

cases of TBI. Catra could tell Mermista was a little pissed at herself for not quickly thinking to do just that after they struggled for almost a solid ten minutes with his symptoms, and as much as Catra sort of wanted to be a good person at that moment, the second one of those god awful clones pulled out his pager she was out of that door before anyone could even blink.

While practically sprinting down the busy, narrow corridor, she couldn’t help but feel her skin burning with the familiar, sickening feeling of eyes upon her. And she knew it definitely wasn’t Scorpia, who, decided to chase her down the length of the corridor panting and yelling at her to slow down. She couldn’t find it in herself to give even half a fuck in that moment, her mind set and focused with one goal.

She just hoped she wouldn’t be too late.

Chapter End Notes

wwerew

this chap took me like three days to finish i swear every time i sat down in front of this godforsaken musty laptop i ended up doing any other activity you could possibly think of instead of even composing one legible sentence.

leave kudos and comments, :D
LOVE YOU DRINK EARTH JUICE MY FRIENDS

Chapter 12

Chapter Notes

hey beautiful person:)

thank you all sm for the kind words last chap, omg<3 you all made me smile so much even my toxic ass friends asked why i was so happy LMAOO

(im so sorry for this btw dont hate meeeeeeeeeeeee)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra practically busted down the door when she finally reached the ICU, bounding past the few other patients that laid side by side separated by the sad blue curtains. When she at last caught up to the end of the room where she knew Adora was suffering, the nurses and another one of Brightmoon's specialising pulmonologists - Doctor Acrea, a quiet, kind older woman - were already frantically making themselves busy at unclamping the bed's creaky wheels. Scorpia quickly dropped by them to help as soon as she entered the room shortly after Catra.

Catra's horrified gaze, however, wasn't on them, but the woman laying in the bed. Adora was more sickly pale than she had been before, but that was the very least of her concerns. Her breaths were small and hardly there, if at all, and getting weaker by every other inaudible exhale. The monitor was beeping erratically as it displayed her decreasing state - one Catra didn't ever want to have imagined Adora getting to.

"Doctor D'riluth, you're here," Acrea breathed out. She, Catra, Scorpia and the nurses all ran out of the room wheeling the blonde alongside with them, attempting to keep her stable with the inflation bag until they reached the ER.

"What - what happened?" Catra asked, gripping the guard rail of the bed as she narrowly dodged her passing colleagues and

patients.

“The ARDS,” Acrea responded as the group picked up their speed to make the closing elevator at the end of the corridor. “It’s worsened, a lot. It’s not allowing her to get any oxygen flow to her other organs and-”

“She’s in respiratory arrest,” Catra finished for her in a horrified realisation as they entered the elevator together. The tight space was thick with urgency to treat the woman as they shuffled to do as best they could. They just had a few minutes before thinks could go even more south than they already were and Adora would go into cardiac arrest.

The time the elevator took to travel from one floor to the next, to the next, was an impossibly long time. Everything felt as though time had slowed right down, everything except for Adora of course. The door finally pinged after it stopped slowly, and the grey metal doors slid open with a quiet hiss. The group quickly ran down another corridor, dodging more people as they made their way to the emergency room.

The second they reached it and the door closed off to the outside, it was their own little world of focus and tenseness. Air was desperately being pumped into Adora’s mouth as the nurses around them were grabbing their tools and medications and equipment. The blonde’s lips had gone a blueish tone at this point, and her nostrils were starting to flare.

“I already checked the carbon dioxide in her blood before you arrived, doctor,” Acrea informed Catra, who was quickly yanking her stethoscope from around her neck and placing the cold diaphragm against her chest. There was a beat of silence in the room, or at least in Catra’s mind. She couldn’t think straight, and it was toeing the line of almost impossible to keep her whirl wind of emotions at a safe enough distance from her work space. She shook her head slightly, and the world snapped back into play.

“She’s not breathing,” Catra barely managed to voice. She pressed her index and middle fingers together and pressed against Adora’s pulse point.

Nothing.

“Doctor D’riluth,” that booming voice came from just outside the small room, Catra whipped her head around quickly to see Prime’s face, red with anger, glaring through the glass. “I gave you strict orders to be working with Doct-”

“Get the crash cart,” Catra yelled at a nurse, quickly moving around the bed to Adora’s left. “Starting compressions,” She placed a hand on her forehead and two fingers under her chin, lifting her head up slightly. She clasped her hands and placed them over Adora’s chest with her elbows and fingers locked, desperately blinking the tears from her eyes. She muttered each count to herself, trying not to let her surroundings of panicked orders and her furious chief and Adora’s *still* absent pulse keep her from doing her job correctly.

She hardly registered when the crash cart arrived by her side, the nurses unbuttoning her hospital-issued nightgown with urgency as she continued the compressions. Two electrode pads were stuck onto her chest diagonal from one another. Acrea was charging the defibrillator as Catra caught Prime’s eye through the glass.

“If you don’t give this up this instant, you will be *dismissed* from this establishment,” he threatened, placing a hand over the cold metal handle, causing it to bend down slightly with the weight. “*Permanently*.”

Catra gave an already awaiting Scorpia an affirming nod, before her friend firmly locked the door. Prime just threatened to *fire* her - and he probably damn well would after that day. But that was a problem for *future* Catra. *Present* Catra had to bring Adora back the fuck to life.

“Clear,” Acrea said loudly, looking slightly shaken from Prime’s interference. Catra removed her hands from Adora’s body and took a small step backwards, and Acrea quickly shocked Adora’s body over the electrode pads. The sound of the large voltage of electricity charging through Adora’s strong frame filled Catra’s ears as she helplessly watched her body move up and down with the force. Her eyes quickly darted to the monitor, which showed that the shock didn’t work.

“Damn it!” Catra yelled, moving back to her chest compressions. “Charge it up again.”

And so the scene played out once more, again proving unsuccessful. One of the nurses looked to Acrea, their expressions exchanging a thousand unspoken words. The nurse sighed, looking at her watch.

“Time of death is-”

“No, no, no, not yet,” Catra interrupted. Her mind was running a rampage as her senses overflowed - the sound of Adora’s flatlining ringing painfully in her ears. “Charge it again.”

Please, Adora, Catra prayed silently.

Stay.

“Clear!”

The blonde’s body convulsed once again with the shock of energy.

Everything was underwater for a moment. Nothing moved, nobody breathed, talked. Catra just stared at Adora’s face, waiting for any sign of life.

And then Catra heard it.

Stars above, she heard it.

She really did not believe her ears. She forced her head to face the monitor, glaring at the bright numbers.

Adora was *alive*.

Catra clamped her teeth together to hold back a relieved whimper that threatened to escape her mouth. Nothing in that moment mattered - not Prime rapping on the door, not the fact she most definitely just lost her job, none of it.

Because Adora was alive.

She felt floaty hooking Adora back up to the vent. No, Adora wasn't out of the woods yet. But there was still hope she would start to heal, she would sit up off that bed and talk to Catra, and maybe finally leave.

The thought of Adora's discharge from the hospital shouldn't have been so selfishly painful as it was.

It was whatever.

She couldn't bite back a small giggle this time, not even as the door unlocked and Adora was wheeled away, or when Prime approached her with a look that could've sent her to her grave.

Adora was alive!

Chapter End Notes

SHE LIVES BITCHES

Chapter 13

Chapter Notes

thank you for clicking:) i hope you like this <3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra followed a storming Prime out of the small room with her gaze glued to the floor ignoring how she could practically feel the anger radiating off her chief. The door shut behind her and she didn't raise her head when he abruptly stopped walking in front of her and she realised they were standing in the middle of the corridor by the front desk.

"Doctor D'riluth, I gave you strict orders which you have failed to comply," he fumed. Catra finally dragged her eyes up, daring to meet his furious glare with one of her own. "You left a critical patient to attend another, against my command."

"That man was fine with Mermista when I left," she spoke out unafraid, and uninterested from the pairs of eyes they attracted from the scene.

"Even so, I believe Miss Grayskull would have been fine without your interference, doctor," Prime riposted.

"No, she wouldn't have," Catra scowled. "They were *calling* it. I ordered the recharge that saved her *life*."

"You still went against orders, did you not, doctor?" Prime circled back. "You understand the financial situation of this institution, correct? You can not simply spend our resources on *lost causes*."

"She *wasn't* and *isn't* a lost cause," Catra growled through gritted teeth.

"What of the truth matters now? I am not one to renege upon my word. You will have until the end of the day to make yourself

scarce, and you are not to return." With his final statement delivered, the man turned on his heel and bounded down the corridor, whatever staff in his way quickly dissipating, with Catra's furious glare following and burning into his retreating form.

Quiet mutters filled the building, many more having seen the interaction. Catra could feel her nails pricking the skin of her palm from how tightly her balled fists were squeezed shut. It had all been laid in front of her, as well as anyone else unlucky enough to have seen. Catra was out, she was fired. The truth felt like a sword through her chest. Sure, it wasn't quite the end of the world. She had enough saved up to move to a new apartment, she could always get a new position in a different hospital. There would be no more Prime, no more Adora taking up every free thought she had. But at the same time, she rather enjoyed that.

She enjoyed the fact that she finally had someone she ached to see in her work life, that didn't already include her friends. Even when Adora couldn't speak or open her eyes, her presence was still warm and inviting. Catra felt like they could've been inseparable from day one in a different universe.

She would be alone now.

Her glare faltered before collapsing. She unclenched her fists and jaw and her head dropped once more. Her vision stung and blurred, she couldn't tell from exhaustion or tears. Scorpia's voice calling her nickname was underwater, nothing happened for a moment before she felt her friend's strong arms wrapping around her. She didn't have the energy to push her away, so stood motionless and let herself be hugged. It was nice.

She didn't know how long it was they stood there before they broke apart, and after they retreated to the break room. A coffee was brewed and placed in her hand before she could even catch up with her surroundings.

"Thanks," Catra smiled weakly, taking a sip of the warm, bitter liquid. The sharp taste that lingered on her tongue brought her

some sort of reality back.

“Are you gonna be okay, Wildcat?” A concerned Scorpia asked from her seat by Catra’s side, absent mindedly swirling a spoon around the steaming liquid in her own mug.

“Yeah, I - I mean… I don’t know,” she sighed. “I’ll figure something out.”

“You did amazing today,” the taller woman tried, placing a hand on her friend’s shoulder, who surprisingly didn’t shrug it off. “Adora wouldn’t be here without you, you know.”

“Yeah, I know,” Catra couldn’t help but feel a tiny smile tug at the corners of her mouth. “Thanks, Scorp. You did great too.”

The next fifty minutes or so were spent with light and easy conversation over small, random topics neither really cared about. Catra was grateful for the distraction, giving her mind space to think about other things than the days unfortunate events. It was peaceful, really, stress free and easy going.

That was, until, *Sparkles* of all people burst the door open, panting.

“Catra, right? You’re Catra?” She smiled victoriously, pacing over to grab the confused woman by the wrist.

“Um, yeah, that’s my name. Look, if this is about Adora-”

“It’s not,” Glimmer yanked her forcefully out of her chair. Scorpia sat and watched, frozen in confusion. “Well, it *is*. But like, I’m not trying to see her right now. Haven’t you seen what’s going on out there?”

“Uh, no? Wait-”

Before Catra could say anything else, Glimmer had dragged her out of the breakroom and started heading down the corridor.

“Perfuma called me about what happened, and I know what you did so this is really unfair. I’ve convinced my mom and Light Hope - er, Adora’s agent - to come down here but you really need to-”

“Slow the fuck down, Sparkles,” Catra growled, yanking her arm back as they both abruptly stopped walking. “How do you know Perfuma? And why the hell is your mom here?”

“I knew Perfuma in college,” Glimmer said as if it was obvious. “And… Wait, you don’t know?”

Silence.

“Ugh, whatever! It doesn’t matter, just come on,” Glimmer started bounding down the corridor again, Catra stumbling to catch up with the shorter girl. She was still lost and had very little faith on whatever Glitter was trying to achieve.

Catra ended up getting dragged right back to the entrance hall, again by the front desk. Prime was there again, as well as Perfuma and who she assumed to be Light Hope and… the mayor? Catra took a few seconds of processing before it clicked.

“*Your mom is the mayor*,” she aggressively whispered to the shorter girl, while she was still trying to decipher the situation.

“Really?” Glimmer rolled her eyes, grabbing her arm again and dragging them up to the others. Catra was immediately met with Prime’s cold glare.

“Doctor D’riluth, is it?” Angella spoke clearly, giving Catra a warm smile, who nodded in return. “I would just like to inform you that you will not be losing your position here at Brightmoon Healthcare Centre any time soon. There seems to have been some *confusion*,” she shot an icy look at Prime.

“Oh, um,” Catra gulped. She looked down, a thousand different emotions flooding over her at once. She swallowed them down enough to croak out a “Thank you.”

“And, Prime,” Angella spoke again, a small smile on her face. “I won’t tell you that I wish I could say the same for you, because I don’t. You will leave this establishment immediately, not to return. I already have a replacement lined up to start tomorrow morning.”

Catra’s mouth fell open, first at the level of absolute *savagery* the mayor just unleashed on Prime. Then, the fact that he just got *fired*. The look of pure shock and horror on his face was enough for Catra too feel instantly giddy with joy, and she had an urge to start bouncing off the walls.

“You are dismissed,” Angella said loudly. Prime scowled one last time before storming away. The second he left the building under the eyes of practically everybody in the area, a loud cheer broke out from the staff. Catra was beaming at Perfuma, who smiled sweetly back. Catra’s mind was filled with a few more seconds of pure bliss before the all too familiar feeling of wanting to see Adora kicked in.

Right, Adora.

She could see her now, couldn’t she? Now Catra would have that chance.

“Fuck, uh, thank you,” Catra rambled to the people around her, directed at who, she didn’t know. “Seriously, I really appreciate it. I just have to go, uh- Yeah. Thanks!” She ignored Perfuma’s knowing raised eyebrow before darting down the other corridor. She would thank them properly later, but for now, she had to go and talk to Adora.

Chapter End Notes

someone make a spotify collab playlist with me <3
~
https://open.spotify.com/playlist/0KpVFMftCRxaaUJKnpmMOh?si=IuvjghyaQ76F2j5IihElYA&pt=4cb625c58c24783f7731c7d4fd80d21c

thank you so much for reading i hope you enjoyed this one:)

Chapter 14

Chapter Notes

> i feel like i havnt updated in forever sorryyyyy so much stuff is happening and my mental health is in shambles but we will power through it adora-style
>
> this chapter is just a short one, but its an adora pov and weve got some catradora softness so forgive me?

See the end of the chapter for more notes

In.

Out.

In.

Out.

Where was she?

In.

Assess the situation. Okay, she can do this.

Out.

She tried to open her heavy eyelids, but she failed. She was so *tired*.

In.

Muffled sounds faded into her hearing lightly. Someone talking, maybe. Nearby.

It took Adora what felt like years to try decipher the situation. Noises, she could see bright lights seeping through her closed eyelids. Her throat was sore and dry, and felt like she had

something lodged in it. Something hurt, but she couldn't figure out where the pain was emitting from. Everything around her felt so familiar but she just couldn't figure out why. Her memory was fuzzy, if there at all.

She willed all of the focus she could muster to concentrate on the noises around her. That would be her biggest clue to the situation, after all.

Sounds of an annoying beeping that reminded her of her alarm clock. Random footsteps and bustling. A voice.

Her brain was still slow to catch up, so she focused hard on the voice. It was clear and slightly raspy and the speaker sounded happy. Still familiar, she knew it but it was only slightly out of reach. The voice continued speaking, sometimes her hearing wavered and the sound came out and back in again, but she was slowly collecting the words.

"…-kicked him out! It was the absolute best. I wish you could've seen it happen, princess."

Princess.

Adora felt a rush of emotions sweep over her, like the feeling when you finally figured out a homework question you've been stuck on for hours. The voice called her princess - it was Catra, wasn't it? Catra was her doctor. Her unreasonably hot doctor, she recalled. And she was *here*.

Adora felt the corners of her mouth turn up slightly - maybe she was imagining it, but it was as close as she could get to the reaction she wished she could've shown. She wanted whatever was down her throat out, she wanted her eyelids to open and she wanted to see Catra again. Her memory of the woman wasn't quite good enough, but it was better than nothing.

In that moment, she wanted nothing more than to spring up and out of whatever her body was restrained to, which she quickly realised would be impossible. Whatever little amount of energy

was left in her was desperately used, and she managed to move a finger.

Catra's voice discontinued sounding in her ears, but before she could sulk over it too much she felt the presence of another hand in her own. She was ridiculously grateful she was too tired for too many emotions to properly impact her, meaning her heart rate wouldn't betray her this time. Hopefully, anyway.

With the warmth of Catra's hand against hers, she tried to move again. After using an embarrassing amount of energy, she managed a light squeeze for a second and a half. A beat of nothing passed, before she felt one in return.

Adora wondered if she was dreaming or not. She wasn't complaining either way.

She didn't know what was to come if she woke up properly. And frankly, she was much too exhausted to go through with her over the top overthinking of the what-ifs that she knew were hiding in a corner of her head. So instead, she allowed the warmth from their connected hands spread throughout her body as she slipped into a light sleep.

Chapter End Notes

last chapter soon i promise you wont be disappointed :D

(i hope anyway fhjcxk)

Chapter 15

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

“You ready?”

“Yeah,” Adora straightened her back, a determined look on her face as she glanced at the clock on the wall.

Catra wouldn’t have believed the day would ever come; the day Adora would be discharged. It was a ridiculously long journey since Catra brought her back to life - not just the endless mounds of paperwork they both had to fill out, but a couple more weeks on the vent, her healing lungs narrowly dodging a dreaded tracheostomy. Her ribs managed to heal naturally after all of her time spent still, as well as her arm. Adora’s determined attitude allowed her physical therapy for her leg to move along quickly and smoothly, leaving her with just a single crutch for support.

The conversation with her about her career in soccer was a long and difficult one. Catra knew realistically Adora must’ve known there would be zero chance she could go back to her usual and familiar exercise routines after everything that had happened. Catra told her that after healing fully, she would be permitted to engage in light sports and gym activities but nothing too hardcore. Really, the conversation included a lot more explanations and warnings and questions and heartbroken expressions than either of them were quite comfortable with.

Soccer. That was one thing that was at the very back of Catra’s mind for Adora’s stay. She forgot that outside the hospital, there was still a whole team and a whole city and probably more that were wondering what was happening to their captain. The nagging voice in her head told her that of course Adora would be swept right up into her old life with her other friends and Catra would just be a memory linked to a terrible experience. Even so,

she was glad to have been part of Adora's life for the short time she had been.

"Nervous?" Catra asked, stepping back from the bed slightly as Adora hoisted herself onto her feet with the aid of her crutch.

"Pssh, no."

"Alright then, hotshot," Catra rolled her eyes but couldn't hide the smirk on her face. "You're friends are probably here by now. C'mon, let's go."

They left the ward together, walking and slightly limping side by side, talking. Catra savored every last word that left Adora's mouth as she desperately tried to muster up whatever courage she could before they got to the exit of the building. She had a plan - she was going to ask Adora out. Right before she left. So even if she did get rejected Adora would be leaving anyway and she wouldn't have to live with that sort of humiliation.

They ended up reaching the large glass doors much sooner than Catra would've liked.

Okay, it's now or never.

They paused their strides, turning to face one another. Catra opened her mouth to pop the question, but no words came out. She found herself falling deeper into the crystal blue oceans that were Adora's eyes. She knew she looked ridiculous, she knew that. But the embodiment of absolute beauty that stood before her wasn't actually making unfreezing and existing like a normal, functioning human being any easier for her.

Ask her now!

Catra moved her gaze to the floor in an attempt to making speaking words possible. She took a deep breath, the question on the tip of her tongue but before she could voice them - Adora's arms wrapped around her frame. Catra started to feel her brain malfunctioning, wrapping her own arms around the other woman

while desperately trying to keep herself on her feet. She didn't know how long they stood like that, melted into Adora's strong frame. It was a cold realisation when they finally broke apart, but not for long as Adora shot her a stupidly cute dopey grin.

"Bye, Catra."

Catra shook her head to refocus, quickly set out her priorities, opened her mouth and-

"*Adooooooraaaa*!"

Before she knew it, Shimmer and Croptop were already dragging Adora by the wrist out of the building, 'thank you's and 'goodbye's thrown out frequently. She deflated, watching Adora retreat with her friends, kicking herself for screwing up. She buried her head in her hands and groaned loudly.

Nice one, idiot.

-

It was the evening. Exactly two minutes until seven p.m. precisely.

Adora felt like a massive idiot standing outside the hospital she was caged in for so long. She had already blown her chance with Catra because she couldn't get her stupid mouth to work, and then she left. Only when she got home did she realise there was no way she spent all this time with the woman and didn't even thank her properly. She had already come to terms with the fact that her chances of asking Catra out were non existent at this point. Which was why she begged a very frustrated Glimmer to drive her twenty five minutes all the way back to the hospital, so she could thank her. And just that. Only.

Right.

She wasn't being creepy. Being stuck alone in that bed for most of the day with Catra usually as her only aid of maintaining sanity, she just so happened to pick up on the time she left every

evening. This whole thing was perfectly normal. It was only a bonus that she could see Catra's face again, and if it were for the last time, at least maybe she could say a proper thank you and goodbye.

A few minutes later, Catra's gorgeous and familiar self exited the building with a bag slung over her shoulder. She was alone, that was good. At least Adora had that going for her.

She casually stepped out from by one of the pole lights and made her way over to the other woman. Catra looked surprised as she approached nearer, and suddenly Adora was starting to have second thoughts.

Well, too late to turn back now anyway, right?

"Hey Adora," Catra said as they finally stood in a closer proximity of one another. She cocked an eyebrow, obviously just as confused as Adora was at her surprise presence.

"Hi," she stuffed her hands into her pockets, running her fingers along the bumps and spikes of her cold metal house key. "I just realised I left a little suddenly earlier, and, uh, I didn't get to thank you properly."

Catra's confusion seemed to clear slightly, but her expression was unreadable.

"Oh, yeah," she responded finally, shrugging. "It's cool."

Great, now she thinks you're insane.

Adora nodded awkwardly, pressing her lips together into an awkward smile before turning on her heel and swinging her crutch around to run back to Glimmer's car so she can die peacefully.

Before she can do just that, Catra reaches her arm out and grabs her hand.

"Wait, Adora, stay."

Ignoring the blazing fire on her cheeks, Adora complied and turned back around to face her.

“Aren’t you going to ask for my number?”

If the question alone wasn’t enough to knock Adora off balance, the smirk on Catra’s face certainly was. She was sure her brain was audibly buffering at this point - apparently, she managed to seduce her doctor with her drool and terrible lungs. Nice, Adora.

Before she forgot how to exist, Catra was already opening her bag and tearing a slip of paper out of a notebook. She took a red pen and messily scribbled a series of numbers and a small note Adora couldn’t quite read in the dark. Catra slipped the paper into her hand when Adora’s brain finally caught up.

“Can I kiss you?” She finally dared herself to ask. She could’ve sworn her heart stopped beating, again, until Catra laughed softly and cupped her hand around the back of her neck. Adora tilted her head down slightly, closing her eyes until finally, *finally* her lips collided with Catra’s.

They were soft, and slightly chapped with the cold breeze, but still one of the most pleasant feelings. She would’ve died again and again for the experience. Adora deepened the kiss slightly, using her free arm to hold Catra’s waist. A few more moments of sheer ecstasy later, they reluctantly broke apart.

“See you around, princess,” Catra breathed out smiling, running her hand back down Adora’s neck before releasing her and stepping back. A dark blush dusted her cheeks as she gave a last, long look into Adora’s eyes before brushing past her into the car park.

Adora remained stupefied to the spot in a daze. She lifted the slip of paper up to see properly, rolling her eyes with a face-splitting smile as she read it.

fight me? ;)

555-1228

Chapter End Notes

helloooo:D

omg guysss. thank you all so so so SO much for all the kudos and comments on each chapter, and for actually reading this. i had no idea it would get this much recognition <3 i seriously appreciate all of you for brightening my day with each commentary and such:)) i had so much fun writing this and i hope you liked it! i dont mind any constructive criticism, after all this project was largely for me to practice my writing in general. anyway, again thank you all SO MUCH for everything :)

merry christmas if you celebrate :D

DRINK SOME WATER OKAY? I LOOVE YOU SO MUCHHHHHHHHHH

End Notes

i cant write really long chapters, im sorry people
i have an update schedule for this but me? organised? h a

leave kudos and a comment because i killed my social life reading about femoral fractures for u guys
(jk i didnt have one to begin with hghfgchjk)

im NOT A DOCTOR, please dont slag me off for my lack of medical knowledge i swear im trying

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!